Gemini Notebook

Ivan Vassilevitch Lomov

The Wealthy Neighbour (Age 35)

Traits: Hypochondriac, highly nervous, suspicious, desperate for a quiet, regular life.

Natalya Stepanovna

The Daughter (Age 25)

Traits: Excellent housekeeper, well-educated, highly quarrelsome, a lovesick cat.

Stepan Stepanovitch Chubukov

The Landowner

Traits: Argumentative, easily enraged, desperate to marry off his daughter.

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Scene 1: The Arrival
The Reality: Lomov stammers out that he has come to ask for Natalya's hand in marriage.
He's come to borrow money! Shan't give him any!
The Reaction:
Chubukov's suspicion instantly vanishes. He is overjoyed, sheds a theatrical tear, calls Lomov his angel, and rushes off to fetch Natalya.
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The Nervous Suitor's Soliloquy

The Critical Age

He is 35. He must marry now to lead a quiet, regular life. He is not looking for ideal or real love.

The Pounding Heart

Suffers from terrible palpitations and extreme physical anxiety.

The Twitching Eye

Highly excitable and permanently stressed. His right eyebrow twitches constantly.

The Sleep Pulls

As soon as he falls asleep, a violent pull in his left side shoots to his shoulder and head, waking him like a lunatic.

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The Proposal Begins

The Struggle

Lomov, shivering from the cold and nerves, tries to build up to his proposal by warmly recalling their long-standing family ties.

The Stop: Natalya interrupts. The proposal is forgotten before it even begins.

The Setup

Natalya enters in an apron, casually shelling peas for drying. She is practical and welcoming.

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Quarrel Act I: The Great Land Dispute

Lomov's Claim

His aunt's grandmother gave the land for the temporary, free use of Natalya's great-grandfather's peasants in return for making bricks.

Natalya's Claim

Both her grandfather and great-grandfather reckoned their land extended to Burnt Marsh, meaning the Meadows have been theirs for 300 years.

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Chaos Escalates: The Family Feud

The Exit: Lomov staggers out clutching his heart, his foot numb, as Chubukov threatens him never to return.

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The Plot Twist: The Reveal

Chubukov complains that the stuffed sausage had the impudence to come make a proposal.

What proposal?! Bring him back! Ah! Bring him here... I'm dying! Fetch him!

The Irony: Upon learning Lomov actually came to propose, her rage instantly transforms into hysterical desperation.

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Act II: The Return (A Second Chance)

The Concession

Natalya desperately backtracks to save the marriage prospect: We were wrong… The Meadows are yours, yes, yours.

The Pivot

She tries to break the awkward silence and force a proposal by bringing up a safe, noble subject: Hunting.

Narrator Box:

“UNFORTUNATELY, HUNTING REQUIRES DOGS.”

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QUARREL ACT II: GUESS vs. SQUEEZER

GUESS

PRICE: 125 ROUBLES

PROS: PUREBRED, FIRM ON FEET

FLAWS: OLD, LAME, AND SHORT IN THE MUZZLE (PUG-JAWED)

SQUEEZER

PRICE: 85 ROUBLES

PROS: YOUNG, THOROUGHBRED PEDIGREE

FLAWS: OVERSHOT (LOWER JAW SHORTER THAN UPPER), TERRIBLE HUNTER

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The Climax: Total Collapse

The Breaking Point

Insults reach peak capacity (Old rat! Jesuit! Pup!). Lomov's fragile heart finally gives out.

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The Ending: Married... but Arguing

The Forced Engagement: Lomov wakes up. Chubukov instantly forces the issue: "She's willing! Kiss and be damned!"

The Irony: Within seconds of claiming they are happy, the newlyweds immediately resume screaming. The curtain falls on their endless quarreling.

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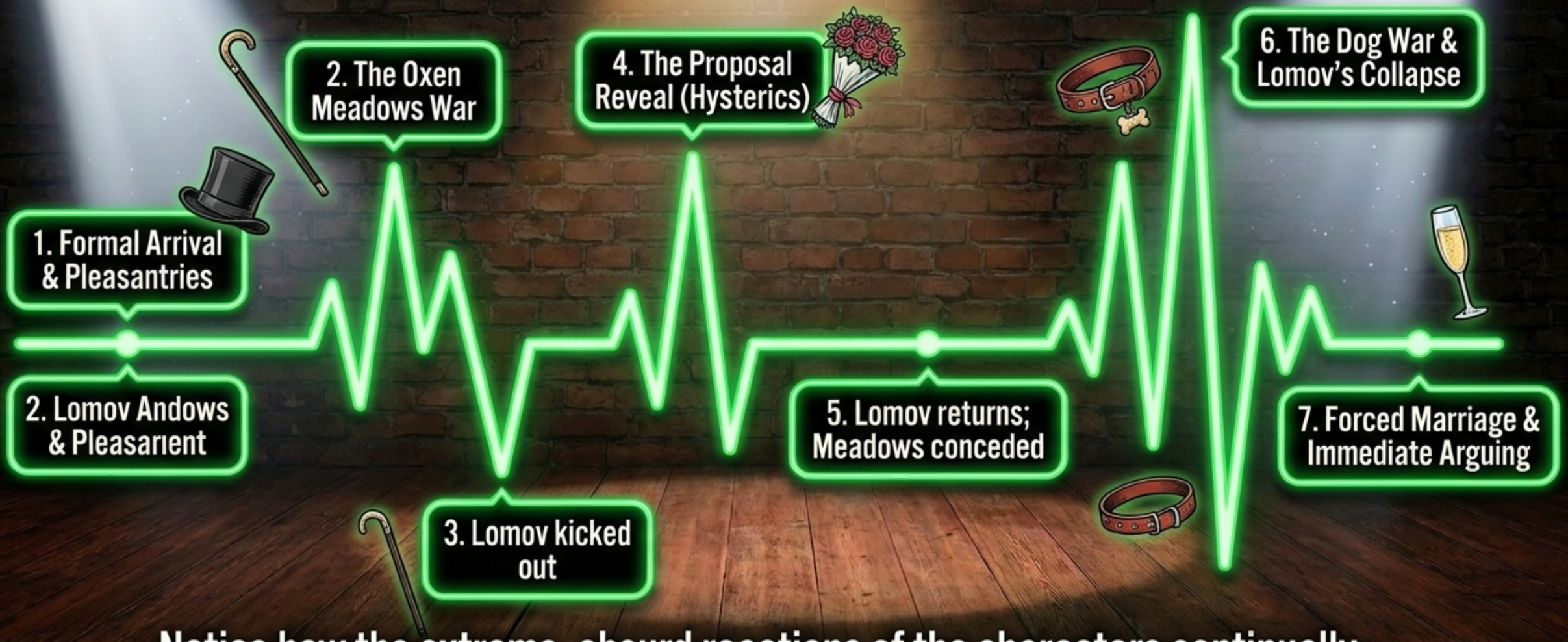
Super Revision: The Farce Timeline



Notice how the extreme, absurd reactions of the characters continually interrupt their economic goals, defining the structure of a Farce.

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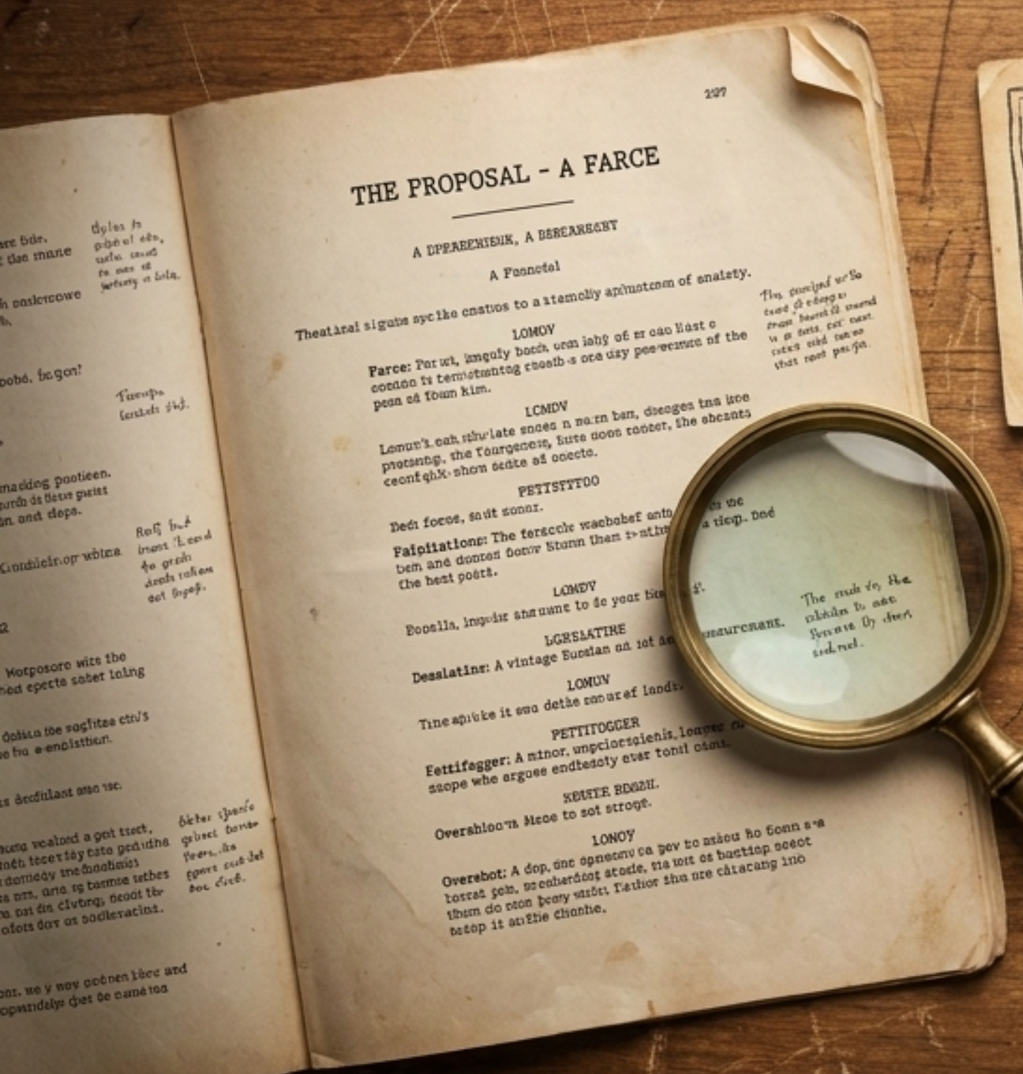
Board Vocabulary: The Director's Lexicon



1

Farce:
A comedy based on highly exaggerated, ridiculous situations rather than character development.

2

Palpitations:
Rapid, strong, or irregular heartbeats (Lomov's primary symptom of anxiety).

3

Dessiatins:
A vintage Russian unit of land measurement (Oxen Meadows = 5 dessiatins).

4

Pettifogger:
A minor, unprincipled lawyer, or someone who argues endlessly over trivial points.

5

Overshot: A dog whose upper jaw extends beyond the lower jaw, making them poor at hunting.

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EXAM READY: Final Curtain Call

Theme of Marriage: Chekhov portrays marriage among the Russian wealthy as a purely economic contract designed to expand estates, entirely devoid of romance or love.

Character Contrast: Lomov's hypochondria and physical weakness vs. Natalya and Chubukov's aggressive, combative energy.

Satire & Ridicule: The play mocks the petty vanity, false pride, and extreme stubbornness of the landowning class who will destroy relationships over trivial patches of land or dogs.

The Ultimate Irony: The couple finally achieves their goal, but their inability to compromise guarantees their married life will be a continuation of their endless quarreling.

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